

SCRUM LEADERSHIP SERIES

Scrum Mastering II: Learning Objectives

Twelve modules. Each module maps directly to one chapter of Scrum Mastering II: Building Great Teams. These objectives are used to demonstrate understanding for the Recognized Scrum Master 2 credential.

The domain of practice and a Practice Partner are part of the learning.

These objectives are not met by recognizing the language or repeating an accepted explanation. The book and the course must be coupled with the learner's domain of practice, where actual conditions, constraints, and evidence give the objectives meaning.

Every learner works with a Practice Partner: another learner, a practitioner within the learner's domain, or a 3Back Expert Echo. For each significant objective, learners explain it in their own words, connect it to actual work, question one another's accounts, test assumptions and competing explanations, and identify the evidence that would support or challenge their conclusions.

The Practice Partner makes the learner's reasoning visible and correctable. The facilitator provides guidance and calibration, but cannot supply the learner's domain experience or establish professional capability for them. Capability develops through repeated judgment, action, and evidence in the work.

Learning approach: This document applies the learning model described in *How 3Back Approaches Learning*, 3Back, September 2026.

3back.com/papers/how-3back-approaches-learning

MODULE 01

Scrum Refresher

- 1.1 Analyze this book's Scrum as continuous flow interrupted by inspect-and-adapt Events.
- 1.2 Distinguish Team Product Owner value accountability from Team Scrum Master improvement work.
- 1.3 Explain why a Scrum Master is not a neutral facilitator on process or teamwork.
- 1.4 Decide when a Scrum Master should stay out of Product Review, Refinement, or Daily Scrum.
- 1.5 Describe DevTeam membership as whoever is producing Results today.

MODULE 02

History, Values, and Principles

- 2.1 Explain empiricism through Transparency, Inspection, and Adaptation.
- 2.2 Interpret the Scrum Values as constraints on how a Team actually works.
- 2.3 Compare Scrum with XP and Kanban as neighboring, not identical, ways of working.
- 2.4 Analyze how Agile Manifesto preferences show up on a live Team.
- 2.5 Apply Lean principles to judge whether work is being pulled or pushed.

MODULE 03

Great Scrum Teams

- 3.1 Distinguish a Working Group from a Real Team using the Katzenbach-Smith J-Model.
- 3.2 Analyze what keeps a group on the Potential Team side of the J-Model.
- 3.3 Describe the shift from individual performance to mutual accountability.
- 3.4 Assess a Team's Working Agreements as the norms that actually govern work.
- 3.5 Diagnose a missing Conflict Resolution Process as a barrier to becoming a Real Team.
- 3.6 Explain High Performance Team as the J-Model step beyond Real Team.
- 3.7 Examine how new members can push a Real Team back toward Potential Team.

MODULE 04

Basic Facilitation Techniques

- 4.1 Apply Full Participation, Mutual Understanding, Inclusive Solutions, and Shared Responsibility.
- 4.2 Facilitate an Open Discussion without forcing premature closure.
- 4.3 Recognize the Groan Zone as divergent perspectives rather than a failed discussion.
- 4.4 Select techniques that organize flow, help people make points, or manage divergence.
- 4.5 Ask permission before stepping in as facilitator of someone else's discussion.
- 4.6 Signal when you are speaking as Facilitator and when you are speaking as Team Member.

MODULE 05

Coaching Techniques

- 5.1 Distinguish Doctor, Expert, Pair-of-Hands, and Trusted Coach stances.
- 5.2 Select a coaching stance that fits the Team's current need.
- 5.3 Apply active listening so the other person is heard before advice is offered.
- 5.4 Use clarifying, reflection, and feedback as coaching moves.
- 5.5 Ask Powerful Questions that put the problem back on the Team.

MODULE 06

Facilitating Formal Meetings

- 6.1 Map a meeting onto the Diamond of Participation from Introduction through Closure.
- 6.2 Work the Groan Zone instead of escaping it with a quick decision.
- 6.3 Distinguish Facilitator responsibilities from Person-in-Charge responsibilities.
- 6.4 Build an agenda with the Person-in-Charge before the meeting starts.
- 6.5 Hold the Person-in-Charge as owner of outcomes after the meeting.
- 6.6 Analyze a Sprint event as a formal meeting with a goal, topics, and desired outcomes.

MODULE 07

Vision and Product Backlog

- 7.1 Use Moore's Product Vision Statement as a starting draft, not a frozen charter.
- 7.2 Build a Story Map that turns a Vision into an Initial Product Backlog.
- 7.3 Distinguish a Strategic Feature Backlog from a Tactical Work Backlog.
- 7.4 Analyze how Vision, Backlog, and Product change at different rates.

MODULE 08

Refining the Product Backlog

- 8.1 Run Example Mapping to expose rules, examples, and questions on a Story.
- 8.2 Split Stories vertically so each slice can still deliver user value.
- 8.3 Apply the cake metaphor to avoid splitting a Story into horizontal layers.
- 8.4 Select a splitting strategy that leaves a Story Ready for Planning.
- 8.5 Contrast how Stakeholders and Developers see the same Story.

MODULE 09

Definition of "Done"

- 9.1 Distinguish Technical Debt, Undone work, and Not Done work.
- 9.2 Separate an Acceptance Criteria checklist from a Standard of Care checklist.
- 9.3 Analyze a Story's Definition of Done as both the right thing and the right way.
- 9.4 Describe Storyotyping as grouping Stories that share a Doneness pattern.

MODULE 10

Team Impediments

- 10.1 Distinguish impediments to Production from impediments to becoming a Great Team.
- 10.2 Use Five Whys, Fishbone, or Causal Factor charts to hunt root cause.
- 10.3 Analyze why treating a symptom leaves the impediment in place.
- 10.4 Connect a removed impediment to a Team improvement, not only a local fix.
- 10.5 Examine Working Agreements as a source of, or a defense against, impediments.
- 10.6 Coach the Team to own removal rather than handing impediments to management.

MODULE 11

Organizational Impediments

- 11.1 Distinguish Organizational impediments from ones the Team can remove alone.
- 11.2 Analyze how Organization culture blocks Great Teams even when Teams want Scrum.
- 11.3 Apply the Extended Agile Manifesto as a lens on Organizational preferences.
- 11.4 Recognize Zombie Scrum as Scrum forms without Scrum results.
- 11.5 Contrast constructive conflict with destructive conflict on a Team.
- 11.6 Choose a Scrum Master response that keeps conflict constructive.

MODULE 12

Scaling

- 12.1 Define Scaling as an Organization's response to increasing demand.
- 12.2 Analyze why adding Developers is a poor first move when Teams are not Great.
- 12.3 Trace Sam's shop through hiring, Product Ownership, splitting, and centralizing.
- 12.4 Compare Feature Teams and Component Teams as coupling choices.
- 12.5 Distinguish Scrum-based scaling from SAFe, LeSS, and Scrum@Scale as this book describes them.
- 12.6 Assess whether a growth move will send a Real Team back to Potential Team.

3Back delivers Scrum Mastering II. RSM2 is recognized by the Scrum Guide Organization. These objectives follow Scrum Mastering II: Building Great Teams by Dan Rawsthorne and Doug Shimp.